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No 105.

Mr Pratt

DEPARTMENT OF STATE
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1874
RECEIVED

U. S. Legation, Japan,
Tokei, July 29, 1874.

Mr Bingham
to the
Hon. Secretary of State.

FOREIGN Relations '74

Subject.

Telegram of Dept. received and notice given to American citizens not to engage in proceedings hostile to China. The Minister for For. Affs. informs Mr Bingham of the result of negotiations with China thus far and of the demand that Japanese troops shall be withdrawn from Formosa.

No. 105.

U. S. Legation, Japan,
Tokei, July 29, 1874.

Sir:

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your telegram of date the 21st instant, in which you instruct me to caution American citizens against hostile proceedings against China. This telegram reached me on the 26th instant at 4 P.M.

I have, in pursuance of

The Honorable
The Secretary of State,

of your instructions, notified our Consuls to warn American citizens not to engage in hostile proceedings against China. On the 28th inst. notices were given by the Consuls at Hiogo and Yokohama, and I presume that notice has also been given by the Consul at Nagasaki in accordance with my instructions sent to him by telegram.

I have carefully considered the 26th Article of the treaty with China made at Tientsin, and consider it highly important to the interests of American commerce that American citizens should not be allowed to violate that provision.

On the 28th inst. ~~I had an interview~~ I had an interview with the Minister for Foreign Affairs in which I told him that while I had respect for the rights of Japan and had no purpose to question her full right to judge for herself touching her relations with China, that it was my duty to acquaint myself, as far

as

as possible, of the actual state of affairs between Japan and China, to the end that the treaty relations of the United States with the two countries might be fully maintained. In this conversation Mr. Terashima informed me that China had made two communications to Japan since the invasion of Formosa by the Japanese forces in relation thereto; first, that the Japanese forces should withdraw from the island, and second, that the Japanese having inflicted

punishment

punishment upon the Boutan savages should at once recall their forces, and China would pledge herself to build a light-house upon the north east coast of Formosa and to furnish protection hereafter to foreign commerce upon that coast by a land and naval force. To my astonishment I was informed that Japan had not accepted either of these conditions, and I was left to infer, therefore, that the conditions were rejected because Japan

purposes

purposes to retain possession of that portion of the island of Formosa. Mr. Terashima also informed me that China has withdrawn her second proposition, and is actively engaged in preparing for war. He concluded by saying that the Japanese Ambassador has reached Peking and is now engaged in negotiations with the Chinese Government, but that he, Mr. Terashima, is not yet advised of the result.

Referring to your Instruction No 43, of date the 6th ultimo, I beg leave

to

to thank you for the expression therein of confidence entertained by the Department in my discretion, and also for the views therein expressed with relation to the scope and effect of the Act of 1860.

I am, Sir,

Your obedient servant,

Jno. A. Bingham